

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Basic Philosophy

- **Internal/Domestic Interests**
 - Political Interests - re-election, what is more popular among people, what ensures less internal friction in the government
 - Economic Interests - profits, creation of jobs, foreign direct investment, etc.
 - Environmental Interests - minimising climate related damages vs balancing economic interests
 - Military Interests
- **External Interests**
 - Image - projection of strength globally (often for future negotiations and setting precedent)
 - Leverage - having anything with you which can help you negotiate a good deal for yourself (prisoner swaps, dependence, etc)

CHINA

- **Political Interests**
 - CCP - Chinese Communist Party - Strong One Party Rule
 - No election, the CCP remains in power always - leadership at the top changes
 - Provincial leaders with minimal power - strongly centralised control (decentralisation means lesser control)
 - Xi Jin Ping constantly faces pressure from within to act decisively
- **Economic Interests**
 - US - China Trade War
 - Fight for who control the semi conductor market - US imposed heavy import duties on chinese made products
 - Massive loss of resources for both parties - still willing to keep duelling with each other for long term gains
 - US doesn't manufacture chips - outsource manufacturing from China's competitors (Taiwan)
 - Dumping
 - Chinese companies (often state backed) flood markets with very cheap goods - easy to outcompete domestic players

- OBOR/BRI (One Belt One Road Initiative)
 - Lends loans to countries - collateral for the loans is often territory (Hambantota Port in Sri Lanka)
 - Lots of countries end up defaulting - China keeps getting the collateral but doesn't get repayment in money
 - Massive infrastructure investments
- Economically under distress
 - Housing Crisis - Oversupply of Houses - not enough demand
 - Lack of repayment of OBOR Loans
 - Manufacturing hit during COVID (companies had to shut down)
 - Aging Crisis - working population downsizing
- Military Interests
 - Control in the South China Sea - territorial disputes with Japan, South Korea, Philippines, Vietnam, etc.
 - Wants control of Taiwan and other autonomous territories
 - Doesn't get involved in foreign wars very often as much as Russia or the USA does

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

- Political Interests
 - Dual Party Democracy - Republican and Democrat. Donald Trump in power
 - Elections every 4 years (Political Competition)
 - Multiple checks to executive power - Supreme Court, the US Congress (House and Senate) - which is important for the functioning of the administration
- Internal Social Dynamics - Immigration
 - Lots of immigrant Communities (African Americans, Latinos, Asians, etc.)
 - Faced massive illegal immigration from bordering countries - Mexico - immigrants often carry fentanyl (drugs), weapons, can be very dangerous (normally escaping tough conditions back home)
 - Trump Admin often very anti immigration, Right Wing Rhetoric against them
 - A lot of 2nd and 3rd generation immigrants are very right wing (Nikki Haley)
- Economic Interests

- US China Trade War - Imposition of tariffs globally on countries who place their import restrictions on US products - actively wants to encourage domestic manufacturing and get jobs back home + ensure China doesn't become economically powerful
- Global Dominance of the US Dollar against other currencies (Indian Rupee is at approximately 90!)
- Continuation of Skilled Immigration - Very Few H1B visas (skilled immigration from abroad)
- Military Interests
 - NATO - North Atlantic Treaty Organisation - Military Alliance with European countries which directly protects their interests (actively involved in the Russia Ukraine Conflict)
 - Extremely Good Friends with Israel - continued to back them in war against Hamas in Gaza (Democratic and Republican governments both)
 - Countering China's military aggression in the South China Sea (often allies itself with all those countries)
 - Security Alliances with Japan and South Korea
 - AUKUS (USA+UK+Australia)
- Other US Politics
 - Abortion Laws
 - Gun Laws
 - Prison Industrial Complex - Police Defund Movement

MIDDLE EAST

- Iran vs Saudi Arabia
 - Saudi Arabia is Sunni dominated, Iran is Shia dominated (fight for who can be the upholder of Islam in the middle east)
 - Yemen
 - Iran backed Houthi rebels in the west and south of the country - significantly influence trade of oil from Saudi Arabia on the Red Sea
 - Saudi backed government internationally recognised
 - Also about the control of Oil
 - Iran also funds other rebel groups - Hamas in Palestine, Hezbollah in Lebanon (both are at odds with Israel)
- Sudan
 - Two militias

- RSF - Rapid Support Force
 - SAF - Sudanese Armed Forces
- Control different territories inside Sudan
- The West and the African Union are generally more SAF supportive, UAE actively (but denies) the RSF with weapons
- Israel Palestine
 - Fight for territory
 - Palestinian government is separate from Hamas
 - The USA and multiple European Countries actively back Israel
 - Palestine has humanitarian support from the rest of the world + actively economic and military support from middle east countries (one issue on which they are united - Saudi Arabia, Iran, Turkey, Oman, Qatar, UAE, etc)

RUSSIA (specifically vis a vis Ukraine)

- Fight for territory - Soviet Union previously or what people know as the USSR
- Ukraine and other countries in Eastern Europe were Soviet Break aways (when it fell in 1990 after the end of the Cold War between them and the US)
- Putin actively supports claims on territory which Ukraine recognises as their sovereign
- Ukraine backed by European Allies (UK, France, Germany, etc)
- Trump Administration has been quite ambivalent and have been shifting stances during the conflict

EUROPEAN UNION

- The UK is not a part of the European Union anymore post Brexit - also have a separate currency - Pound
- Every country in the EU uses the Euro
- Western European Countries - France, Germany, etc - no historical Russian Influence, economically much better situated and are richer countries - proportionally have more power in EU's decision making
- Eastern European Countries - Serbia, Croatia, Bosnia-Herzegovina, etc - former Soviet Break away countries hence have influence, generally much poorer and hence have lesser say in EU's decision making

AFRICA

- Wave of anti democratic military coups (referred to as the Sahel States)
 - Niger

- Mali
 - Burkina Faso
- Pulled out of the ECOWAS - West backed alliance of African nations which are democracies- imposed sanctions on these military juntas
- Previously has massive french influence (were French colonies previously) - now scaling back and Russian investments on the rise